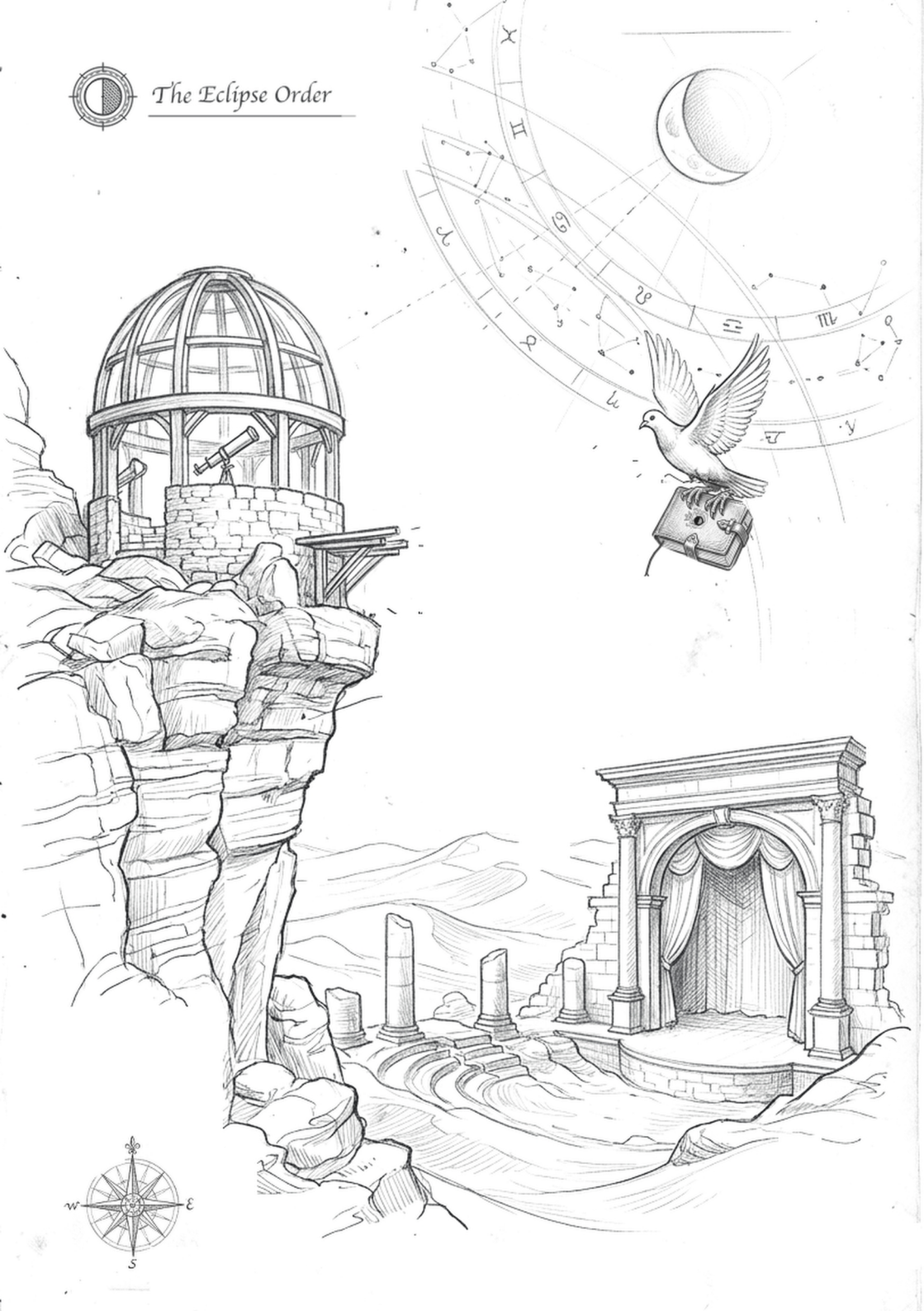
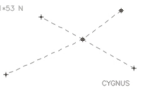

W
E
S

The Uncharted Path

For centuries, our order believed every path had already been mapped. We were wrong. The old kingdom left trails that appear on no atlas, hidden markers waiting for someone to connect them across the land.

My search began in the desert ruins, tracking symbols carved in stone. Every clue points toward a forgotten network of sanctuaries. The first three markers are verified.



The Astrolabe we recovered is only one piece of a much larger puzzle. It does not point to ordinary stars. When aligned with the old towers, its dials reveal landmarks that should not exist on our charts.

I have gathered all my observations, routes, and sketches in this book. Step by step, the pieces are beginning to form a single continuous route. There is still much ground to cover before the full map is revealed.

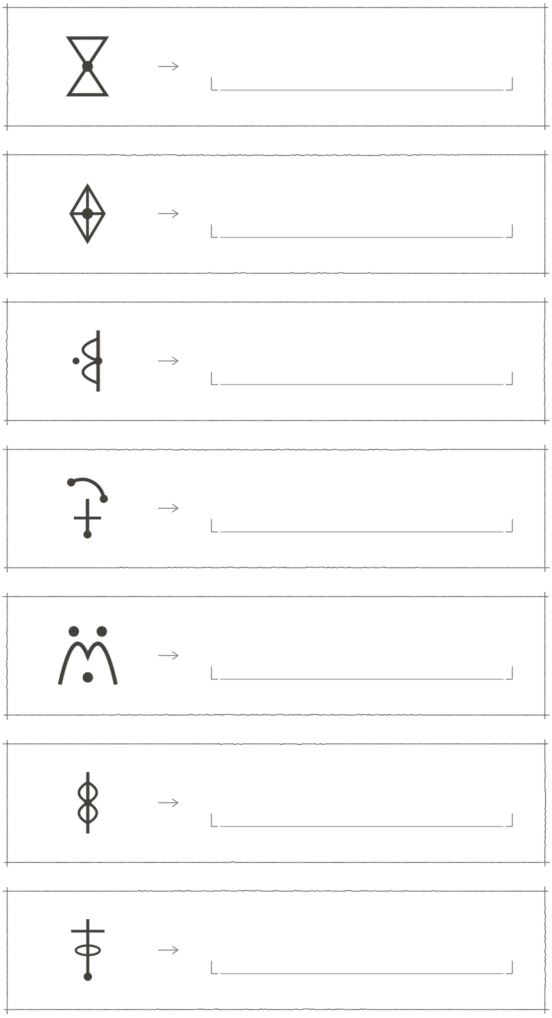
Tonight I head north to follow the trail into the mountain pass. If you hold these notes, follow the clues in order and trust your instincts.

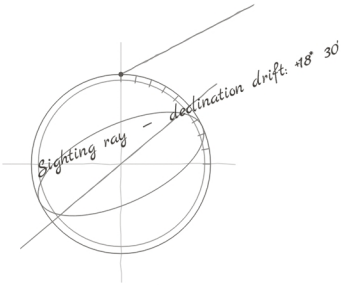
The path is real. We just have to walk it.

The Cartographer

The Celestial Alphabet

These are the symbols that govern the heavens; the contours with which the ancient sanctuaries speak. I have recorded the twenty-six signs uncovered across the ruined towers of the desert kingdom. Study their geometry. Every dial and threshold responds to this script.

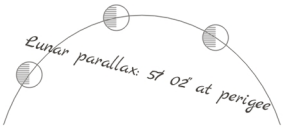




Celestial sighting ring

Spurious sign — non-phonetic

Datum: Delta = 38° 14 22″



Ephemeris progression — Sector II

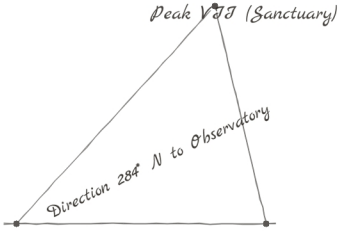
Field Trigonometry Pad

d = B . sin(a) / sin(g)

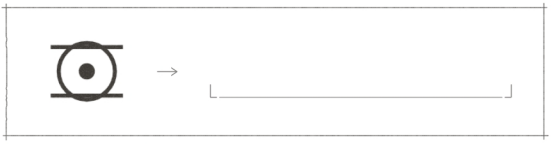
d = 3,840 paces → 3,912 paces (corr.)

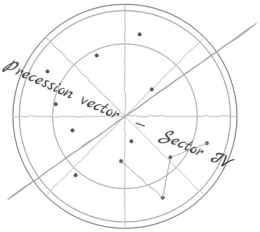
Zenith elevation h = 412 paces

Midday heat shimmer compensated

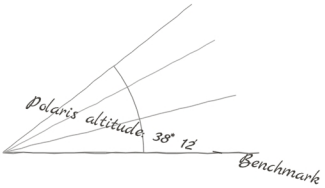


Baseline: 4,200 paces

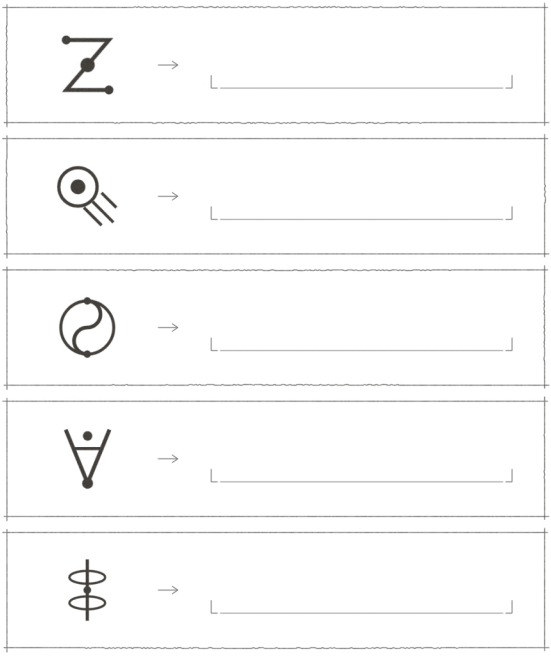


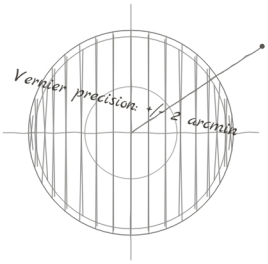


High Desert Planisphere

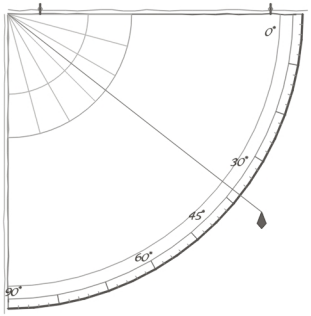


? architectural seal — non-phonetic





Fixed datum benchmark
Foundation stone



Cartographer's Meridian Quadrant
Elevation index: 38° – Polaris alignment

Convergence of the Bearings

This celestial alphabet is not a code of words,
but of directions and coordinates.
Each mark represents an ancient path carved in stone,
waiting for the observer to align it with the horizon.

Follow the clues in strict order of discovery.
What appears silent in these folios will reveal
its meaning when the ancient sanctuary is reached.

Trust the geometry. The stars do not deceive.

~~word translation~~ → star alignment only

Micrometer tangent graduation – Base horizon

The Cartographer

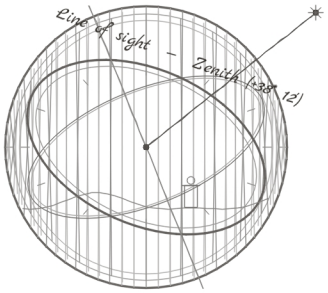
Carved in the high desert, beneath the zenith of the solstices.

The Astrolabe

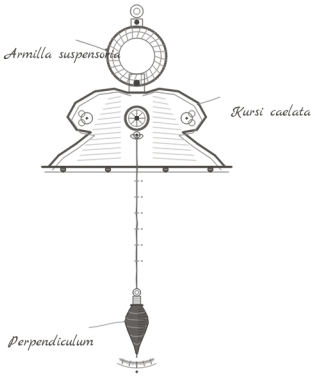
For three centuries, the Order believed the ancient sanctuary was sealed by key or word of mouth. They were mistaken. The great threshold yields only to the sacred geometry of heaven.

This instrument—the Astrolabe—is the true key. Forged from cold brass and meteorite alloy, its plates capture authentic movement of stars upon a single stereographic plane.

Whoever aligns its rings with the midnight horizon can uncover the hidden bearings of the desert vaults. I recorded its anatomy here before the riders crossed the perimeter valley. Study every plate with care.



Projection of the Celestial Sphere



The Suspension Throne (Armilla)
Suspended by silk thread for true vertical plumb

Meridian alignment zero

Three Rules of the Outer Dial

I. Never force the rete when the desert wind rises. The fine pointers bend under grit; once warped, a star bearing can mislead by a dozen leagues.

II. The central pin locks with an iron horse wedge. If the wedge slips, the altitude circles decouple from the true horizon of the sanctuary.

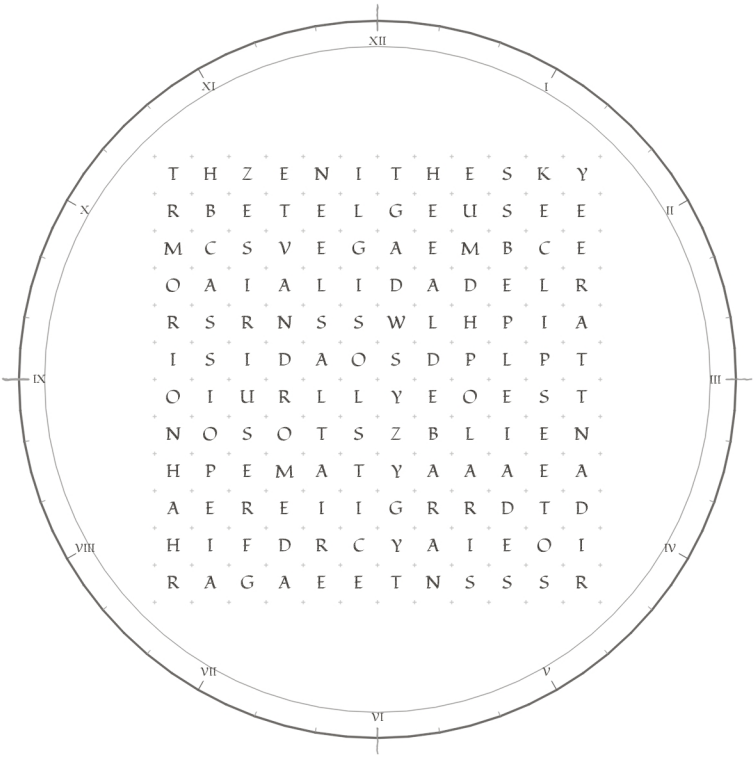
III. Trust the shadows at noon, but trust the pointers at midnight. When Vega reaches zenith, the gate alignment reveals its true direction.

Aequatio Temporis — Epoch of Observation
Solar declination: delta = 23° 27′ · sin(lambda)
Solstitial limit: maximum elevation h = 75° 15′

"To hold the sky in one's hand is to master the path beneath one's feet."

Latitude datum: 38° 12′ 04″ N — Meridian of the First Tower

The Planisphere



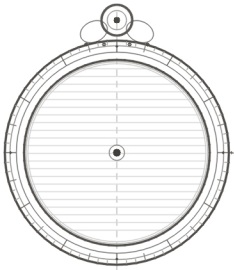
Locate and circle the sixteen celestial guides in the starfield:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____

Anatomy of the Artifact

I. The Mater (The Mother)

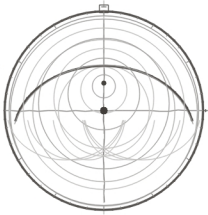
Heavy outer bronze casing
holding internal plates.
Limbus divided into 24 hours
and 360 angular degrees.
Recessed bed prevents warping.



The Mater: 360° limbus & base frame

II. The Tympan (Horizon Plate)

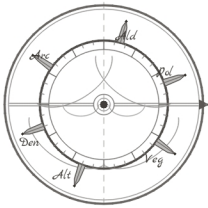
Exchangeable disc engraved for
Latitude 38° 12 (Sanctuary Datum).
Stereographic curves show altitude
circles converging at the zenith.



The Tympan: Almucantars for Lat. 38° 12

III. The Rete (The Star Web)

Openwork bronze skeleton of sky.
Concentric ring traces the zodiac.
Flame pointers mark guide stars.



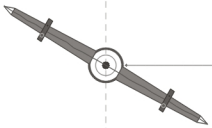
The Rete: Ecliptic band & 6 star pointers

The 6 Star Pointers
1. Ald – Aldebaran (Taurus)
2. Pol – Polaris (Ursa Minor)
3. Veg – Vega (Lyra)
4. Alt – Altair (Aquila)
5. Den – Deneb (Cygnus)
6. Arc – Arcturus (Bootes)

Flame tips indicate sidereal hours on limbus

IV. The Alidade (Sight Rule)

Revolving sighting ruler on back.
Dual pinholes measure star altitude.

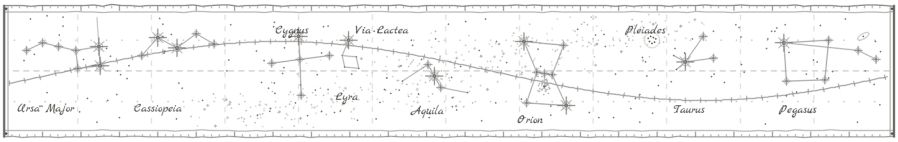


The Alidade: Elevation sighting ruler

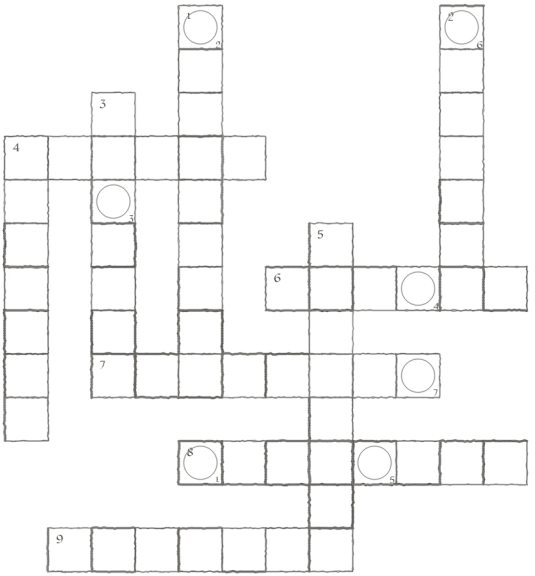
V. The Horse Wedge (Equus)

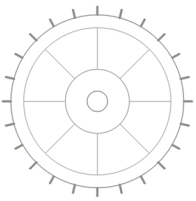
Traditional locking wedge holding plates.
Slips out instantly to swap horizons.

The Horse Wedge: Locks central axis pin



The Zodiacal Engine





Across (The Horizontal Circles)

4. The point where a wandering star or moon is farthest from Earth.

6. The highest point of the celestial dome, directly overhead.

7. The longest noon, when the sun reaches northernmost declination.

8. The great golden track traced by the sun through the twelve houses.

9. The boundless ring where earth meets the dome of heaven.

Down (The Vertical Planes)

1. Of the heavenly sphere and its ancient revolving harmonies.

2. The brass arc used to measure the angular height of the stars.

3. The northern pivot of heaven, steady guide of nocturnal mariners.

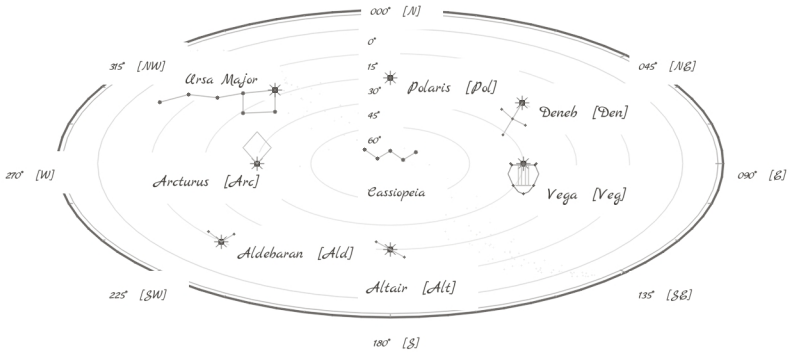
4. The revolving sight rule that aligns with distant beacons.

5. The great noon circle passing through observer and both poles.

The Master Key (Assemble the seven numbered circles 1 to 7):

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

The Midnight Calibration



Procedure for True Sanctuary Alignment

1. Suspend the astrolabe by its silk cord until the plumb bob hangs steady.

2. Rotate the alidade ruler toward Polaris; lock the elevation index at 30°.

3. Turn the Rete star web until the pointer of Vega matches the 45° altitude circle.

4. Read the resulting perimeter mark: this angle points toward the mountain vault.

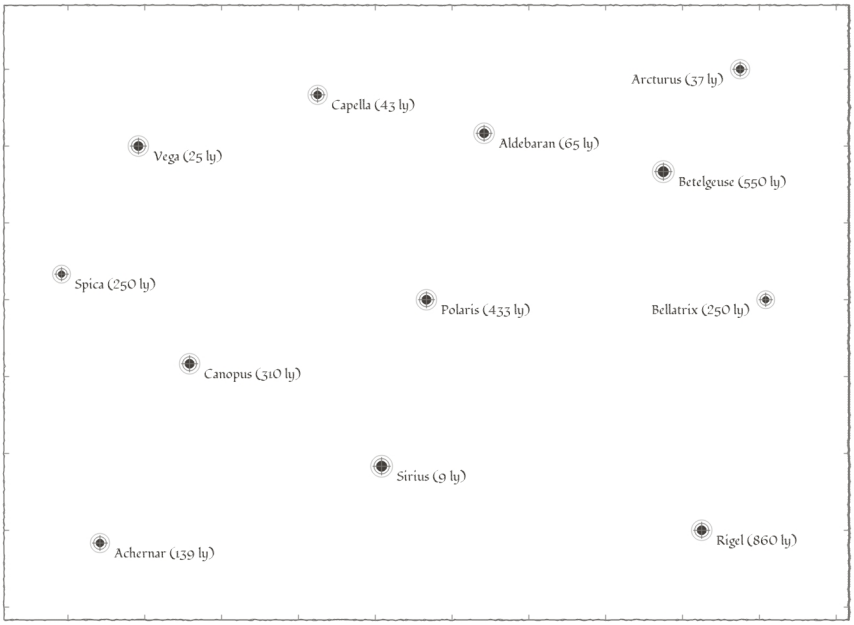
Field Observation Log: Star Altitudes & Bearings

Target Guide Star	Measured Altitude	Horizon Bearing	Sanctuary Delta
Polaris (Ursa Minor)			
Vega (Lyra)			
Arcturus (Bootes)			
Aldebaran (Taurus)			
Deneb (Cygnus)			
Altair (Aquila)			

Sanctuary Calibration: Delta = (Horizon Bearing + Measured Altitude) - Latitude 38°

Six celestial alignments recorded. Only one unlocks the mountain vault, yet none know which until tested.

The Midnight Transit



The Six Chords of Distant Light (Trace with straight edge):

I. Depart from Achernar (139 ly). Sights the southern pivot.

II. Draw to the blue supergiant whose distance in light-years equals 139 + 721.

III. Traverse north-northwest to the red giant where starlight departed 860 - 310 years ago.

IV. Cast the third chord across the heavens to the orange beacon at 550 - 485 light-years.

V. Ascend along the meridian to the northern beacon of Capella.

VI. Close the celestial circuit by plunging to the true northern axle: Polaris.

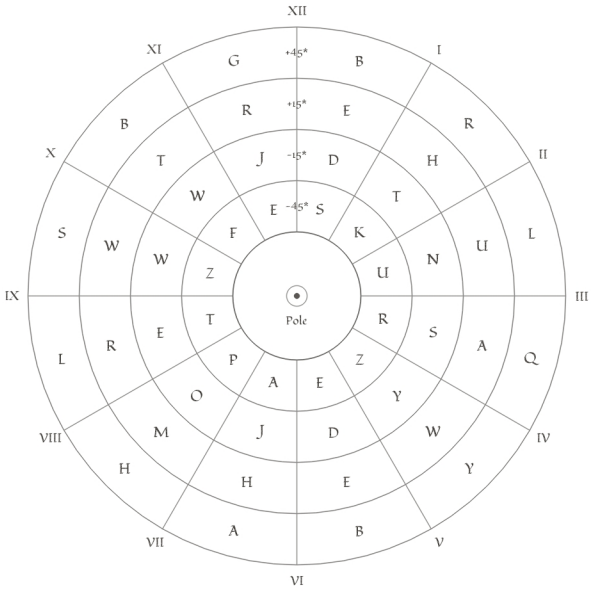
Observation Log & The Hidden Asterism:

1. Sum of the Six Stellar Chords: [___] + [___] + [___] + [___] + [___] + [___] = [_____] ly.

2. The geometric polygon revealed by the six chords: [_____].

3. The two celestial anchors bridging southern and northern poles: [_____] & [_____].

The Celestial Cipher



Sighting Log: Cross the Hour Angle with the Declination Ring:

I. The Seeker's Identity: (IV, +45*) (VII, -15*) (II, +15*)

II. The Past Meridian: (IX, -15*) (V, +15*) (I, +45*) (XI, -45*)

III. The Timeless Stance: (III, +15*) (VIII, +45*) (X, -15*) (VI, +45*) (IV, -15*) (XII, -45*)

IV. The Definite Sun: (I, -15*) (VII, +45*) (V, -45*)

V. The Final Mystery: (X, +15*) (III, -45*) (VIII, -15*) (VI, -45*) (IX, +45*) (II, -45*) (XI, +15*) (XII, +15*)

The Decoded Prophecy of the Cartographer:

I ☐☐☐ II ☐☐☐☐ III ☐☐☐☐☐☐

IV ☐☐☐ V ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐

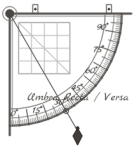
The Cartographer

Field Log: The Desert Frontier

Autumn, 1998 — Twenty-eight years before the Call.

I. The First Crossing into the Red Sands

I was twenty-four when I left the Sanctuary library behind, carrying only my brass quadrant, unfinished star plates, and the elder's forbidden charts. The scholars believed the desert was a barren waste of dead stone. They could not understand that the sand is the purest mirror of the cosmos; here the flat horizon allows the curvature of the earth to be weighed directly.



Surveyor's Altitude Quadrant (90°)
Polaris Alt. Reading: 30° 00′ N

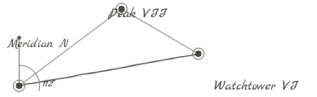
II. Astronomy of the Dunes

For fourteen nights, I measured the altitude of Polaris from the dry ridge. At local midnight, the north star hangs fixed at thirty degrees above the horizon, anchoring the great turning vault of the night sky. By calculating the sun's meridian shadow at noon, I confirmed what was written: this latitude is no accident. It marks the fourth harmonic of the astrolabe.

III. The Three Cairns & The Copper Benchmark

Before ascending to Outer Watchtower VI, I surveyed the dry wash bed below. To mark the route for the seeker who would one day follow my footsteps, I raised three stone cairns along the canyon wash, pointing south-southeast. Beneath the foundation stones of Cairn III, beneath a flat red sandstone slab, I buried the first copper benchmark plate engraved with the bearing of 112 degrees.

Geodetic Triangulation Study



Station 0 (Wash)
Base Baseline: 5,420 paces to Red Ridge
Watchtower VI Bearing: 112° East
Magnetic Offset: +04° 15′ (True N. Corr.)
Apex Elevation (Peak VIII): 1,240 varas

The Desert

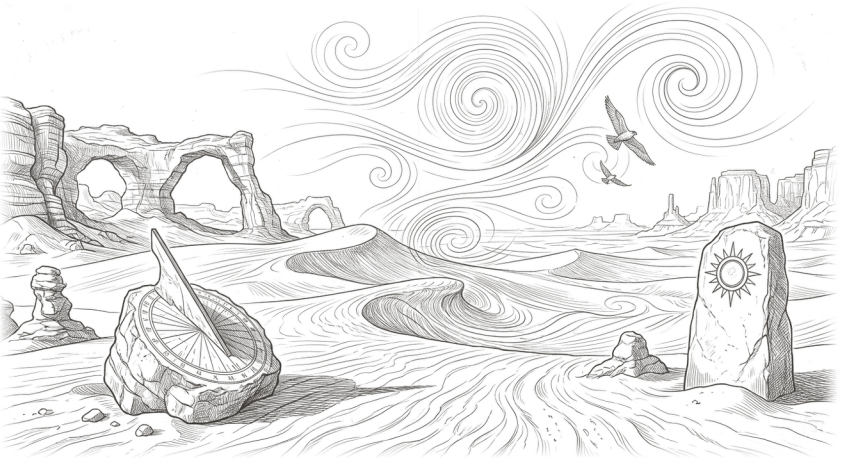
Of Sun, Silence, and Buried Stone.

I. The Mirror of the Earth

The scholars call the desert an empty wasteland, for they only value what can be harvested. Yet the sand is the purest archive of the Order. The dry wind strips away every illusion, every tree, every wall of clay, until only the ancient bedrock remains. What is written in the city is forgotten by morning; what is buried beneath a flat red sandstone slab remains untouched for a thousand years.

II. The Voice of Shadows

Deep within the sandstone canyons dwells the second guardian: The Oracle. She wears no face, speaks no idle words, and leaves no footprints upon the dunes. When the wanderer brings a question, she points only to the earth and the sun. Do not ask where the road leads; ask where the sun casts its weight. The shadow is the only compass that never forgets the light.



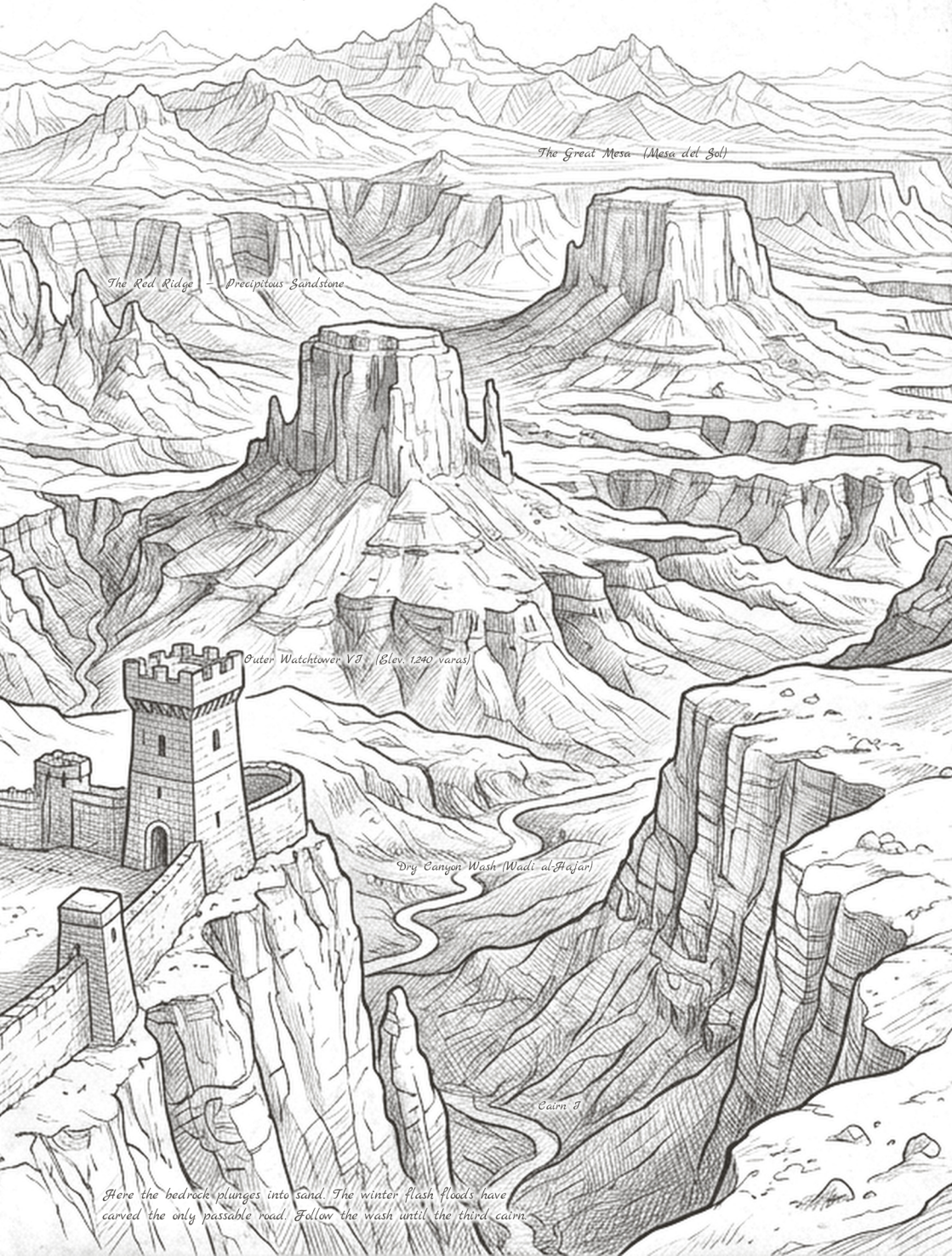
III. The Three Laws of the Waste

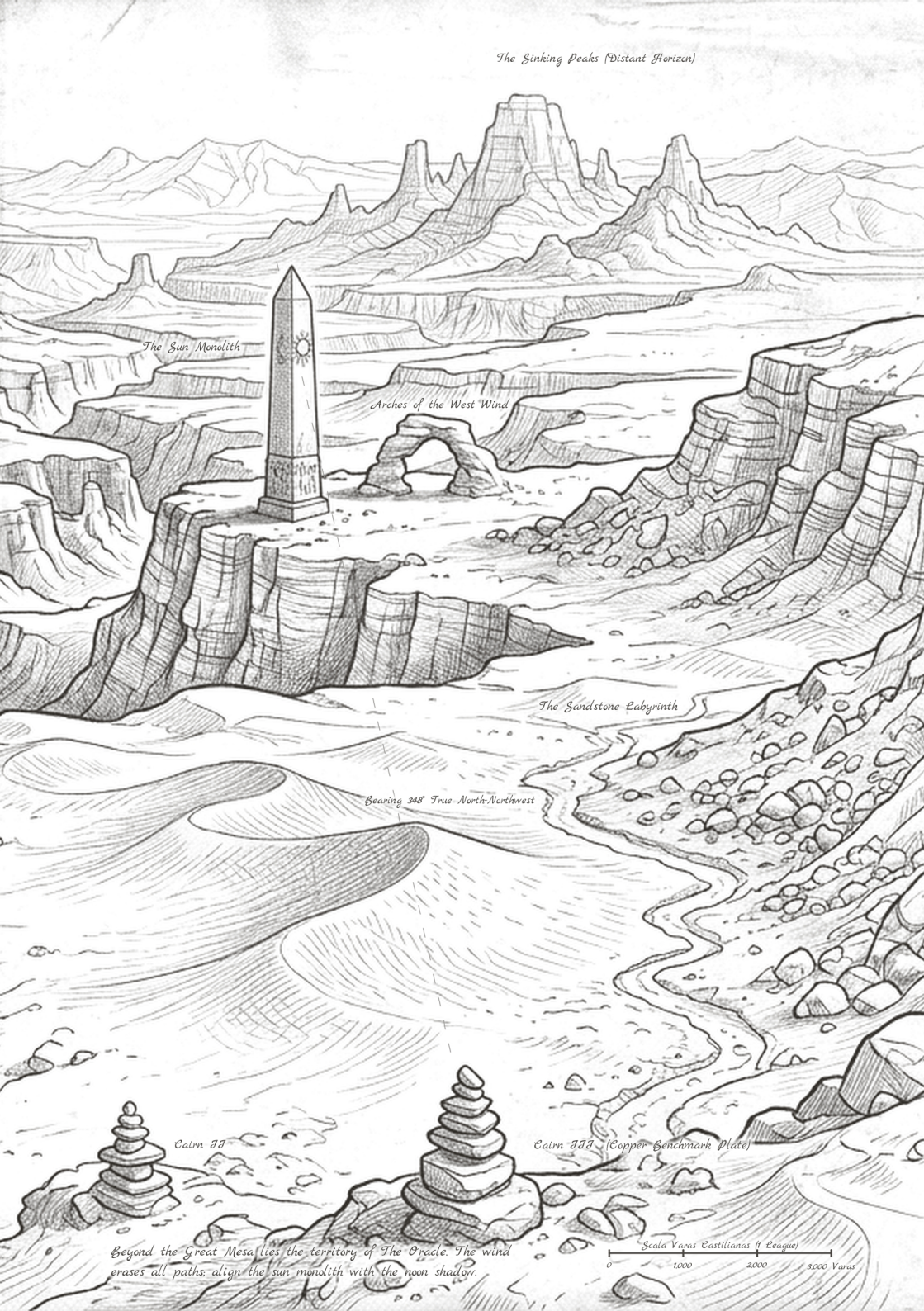
1. The Meridian Shadow
   At true solar noon, the gnomon casts its shortest shadow along the meridian line. Only then is true north revealed, pointing toward the ancient observatory.
2. The Dry Wash
   Where winter flash floods once carved the sandstone, the gravel bed packs firm. It is the only safe passage through the labyrinth of sheer mesas and red canyons.
3. The Benchmark Plate
   Three cairns of dry stone mark the southern turn into the wash. Beneath the foundation slab of the third lies the copper plate, aligned to the bearing of one hundred and twelve degrees.

What the wind covers, the sun shall reveal.

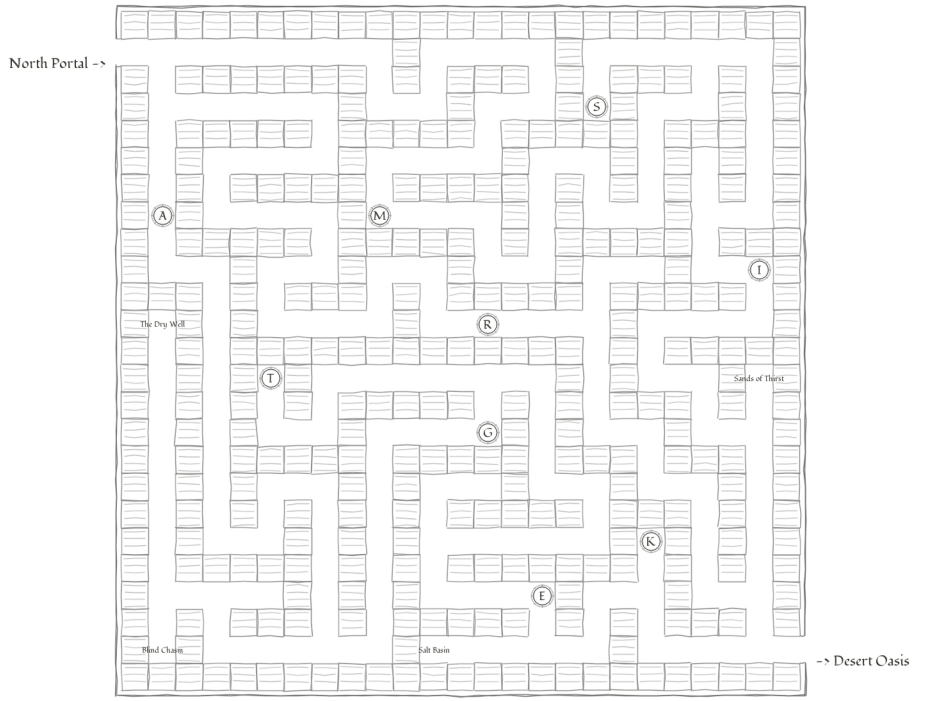
The Desert Frontier

Northern Approaches & The Red Ridge · Latitude 30° 00′ N




The Sinking Peaks (Distant Horizon)
The Sun Monolith
Arches of the West Wind
The Sandstone Labyrinth
Bearing 348° True North-Northwest
Cairn II
Cairn III — (Copper Benchmark Plate)
Beyond the Great Mesa lies the territory of The Oracle. The wind erases all paths; align the sun monolith with the noon shadow.
Scala Varas Castilianas (1 League)
0
1000
2000
3000 Varas

The Whispering Chasm



The Law of the Canyon Walkers:

1. Never retrace your steps: no corridor or junction may be trodden or crossed more than once.

2. Beware the swift path: the shortest way to the Oasis is a deceitful lure that skips the relics.

3. You must discover and collect all six sacred runes in strict sequence before reaching the Oasis.

4. Ponder each turning with care; entering a blind gorge or missing a rune will doom your passage.

The Nomad's Passphrase (The Six Relic Cairns):

Inscribe the six sacred runes in order of discovery:

1	2	3	4	5	6

The Salt Playa (Dry Basin)

1. Start at Row I, Column D (marked with 3 and [C]).
2. Advance one row per step, traveling from Row I down to Row VII.
3. Move only to an adjacent cell in the row below (straight down or diagonal).
4. Cells marked with [X] are impassable sinkholes. Never step on them.
5. The number in each step must be exactly 1 higher or 1 lower (+1 or −1).
6. The letters along your 7-step path reveal the passage keyword.

	COL A	COL B	COL C	COL D	COL E	COL F	COL G
ROW I	1 [M]	5 [X]	6 [B]	3 [C]	1 [Q]	6 [Z]	2 [V]
ROW II	4 [G]	2 [E]	X	6 [K]	4 [R]	1 [J]	5 [U]
ROW III	3 [F]	X	2 [I]	5 [Y]	X	2 [P]	6 [D]
ROW IV	5 [O]	1 [A]	4 [S]	2 [W]	X	5 [B]	3 [T]
ROW V	2 [L]	X	3 [T]	6 [H]	1 [N]	X	6 [M]
ROW VI	6 [K]	5 [N]	X	2 [A]	5 [R]	3 [E]	1 [S]
ROW VII	3 [P]	1 [Z]	4 [O]	1 [L]	X	6 [C]	2 [Y]

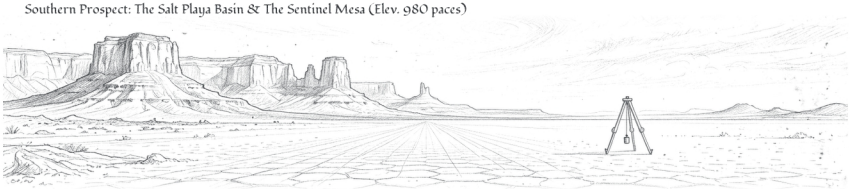
The 7 Stepping Stones Waypoint Log (North to South Transit):

ROW I	ROW II	ROW III	ROW IV	ROW V	ROW VI	ROW VII
[___]	[___]	[___]	[___]	[___]	[___]	[___]

Passage Keyword: [___] [___] [___] [___] [___] [___] [___]

Transmit the 7-letter keyword to the Web Navigator Console to unlock the South Shore.

Southern Prospect: The Salt Playa Basin & The Sentinel Mesa (Elev. 980 paces)

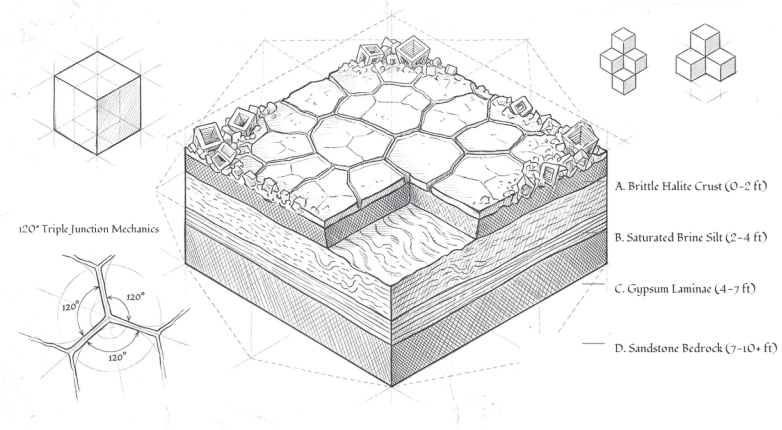


Study on the Dry Salt Playa

I. Mechanical Principles of Crust Buckling & Desiccation

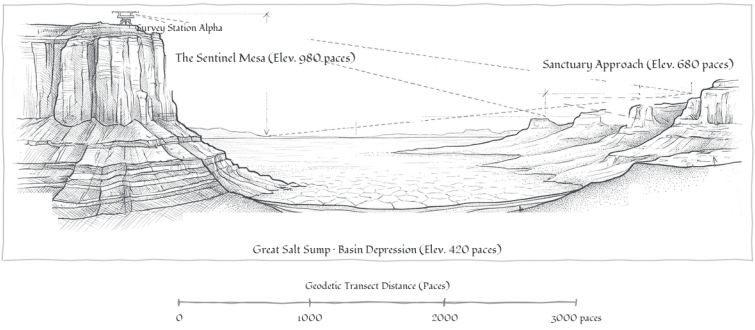
As solar heat bakes the playa, capillary suction pulls saturated brine up through fissures.
Crystallizing salt expands by volume, forcing polygon plate edges to buckle into sharp ridges.
Where subterranean waters dissolve the silt from beneath, treacherous sinkholes form unseen.
The traveler must test every slab before bearing full weight, as dry crusts conceal deep brine.

Fig. I - Morphological Cutaway of the Salt Playa & Halite Crystallography



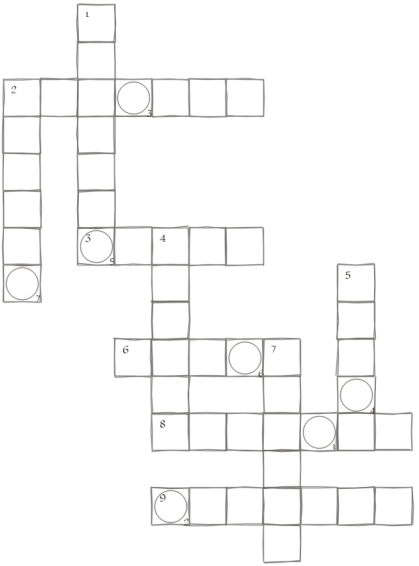
II. The Architect's Note (Field Codex Entry):

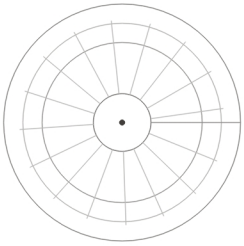
«The water that flows carries the memory of the heights; but the salt that remains
is the crystal skeleton of the earth, holding the light long after the storm has turned to dust.
Let the seeker who traverses the playa walk with measured footsteps,
for weight without balance yields perpetually to the deep beneath.»



The Desert Lexicon

Inscriptions from the Bivouac of The BC Ashes · Al-Qibla Vector 194° SSW





Al-Qibla & Desert Bearing

Across (The Lateral Trails)

2. The blistering south-easterly wind that sweeps the dunes and erases all travelers' footsteps.

3. The eternal wanderer whose only roof is the starry vault and the desert horizon.

6. A verdant sanctuary where hidden subterranean springs quench the thirst of weary pilgrims.

8. The sacred occultation when the noon sun is crowned in darkness by the celestial disk.

9. The boundless circle where the burning desert sands meet the eternal vault of heaven.

Down (The Vertical Meridians)

1. The solemn march of laden camels and merchants navigating by nocturnal stars.

2. The stone guardian of ancient dynasties, keeping silent watch over the golden sands.

4. The shimmering illusion of non-existent waters conjured by heat above the scorched basin.

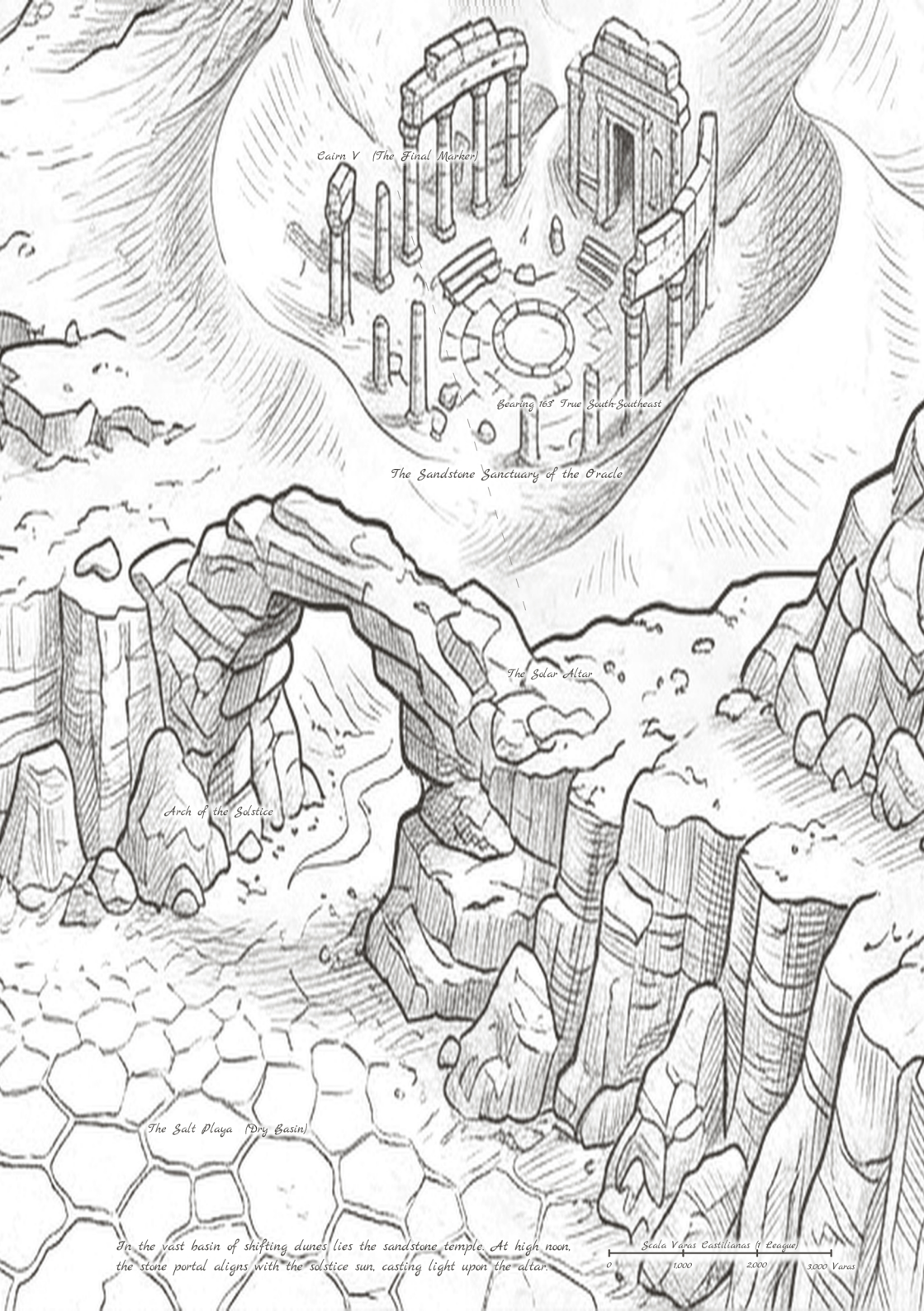
5. The shifting hills of golden powder, sculpted and reshaped by the midnight breeze.

7. The unseen whisperer of the desert expanse, whistling through the sandstone canyons.

The Desert Sigil (Assemble the circled letters in order 1 to 7):

1	2	3	4	5	6	7

The canyon fractures into deep alluvial gravel. Follow the descending wash past the fourth cairn. Where the dry bed turns eastward, the open sands begin.


Cairn V (The Final Marker)
Bearing 163° True South-Southeast
The Sandstone Sanctuary of the Oracle
The Solar Altar
Arch of the Solstice
The Salt Playa (Dry Basin)
In the vast basin of shifting dunes lies the sandstone temple. At high noon, the stone portal aligns with the solstice sun, casting light upon the altar.
Scala Varas Castillianas (1 League)
0
1000
2000
3000 Varas

The Oasis Clepsydra

Feverish Mirage of the Siphons - Maintaining Lucidity across the Salt Basin

	WELLS				ARRIVAL HOURS				SACRED RELICS			
	Falcon	Jackal	Scarab	Serpent	Hr III	Hr VI	Hr IX	Hr XII	Astrolabe	Scarab	Sandglass	Dagger
The Cartographer												
The Alchemist												
The Nomad												
The Astronomer												

The Five Testimonies of the Shadow Index:

I. The traveler bearing the Brass Astrolabe arrived at their well exactly three shadow-hours before the arrival of the Nomad.

II. The seeker at the Well of the Jackal arrived earlier in the day than The Cartographer, but was never seen in possession of the Obsidian Dagger.

III. The arrival at the Well of the Falcon occurred strictly later than that at the Well of the Scarab, though neither of these two arrivals took place at Hour XII.

IV. The Astronomer carried the Gold Scarab and reached the Well of the Serpent, yet their camel was not unburdened until the ninth shadow-hour or later.

V. The Alchemist possessed the Silver Sandglass, and quenched their thirst at an earlier hour than the seeker who carried the Brass Astrolabe.

The Oasis Registry (Transcribe the Verified Seekers):

1. The Cartographer : Relic [_____] | Well [_____] | Arrival [_____]

2. The Alchemist : Relic [_____] | Well [_____] | Arrival [_____]

3. The Nomad : Relic [_____] | Well [_____] | Arrival [_____]

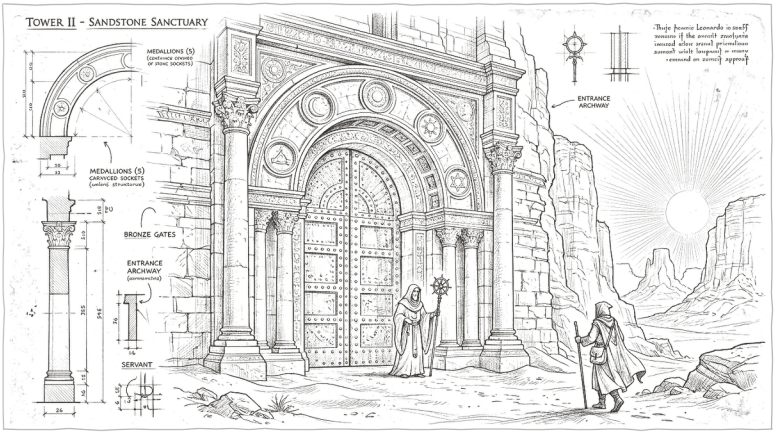
4. The Astronomer : Relic [_____] | Well [_____] | Arrival [_____]

The Clepsydra Key: Sum of the Four Arrival Hours = [_____] (Roman Numerals) = [____] Hours.

At the Gates of Tower II

I. The Sandstone Sanctuary

At the western margin of the salt playa rise the colossal ramparts of Tower II. Here, carved deep into the sheer red cliffs, stands the Sandstone Sanctuary of the Oracle. Fluted columns of living rock frame an ancient archway sealed by heavy bronze gates. In the shadow of the portico stands the Sanctuary Servant, an elder of the Order guarding the threshold with an iron staff topped by a celestial star-sight.



II. The Demand of the Five Seals

No traveler may step beyond the gates without offering proof of their survey. When I presented the carved stone seal recovered from the dry riverbed, the guardian studied its geometry in silence, then pointed his staff to the five empty sockets set into the arch: «You have found the first seal by following the dry wash, but four still sleep in stone. Five sacred cairns were raised by our founders to measure this desert. Return to the sands and complete the meridian survey, or these gates remain closed forever.»

III. The Great Circuit

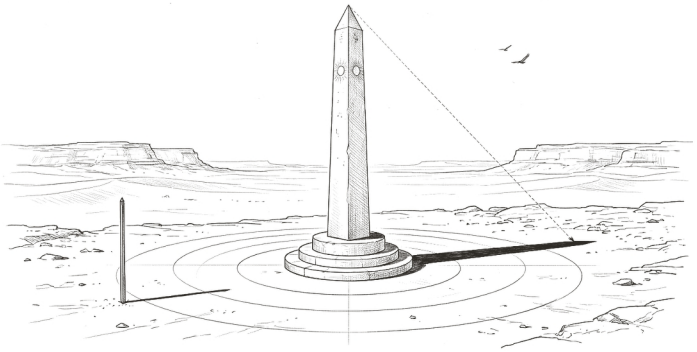
Cairn I	Cairn II	Cairn III	Cairn IV	Cairn V
Seal acquired	Seal missing	Seal missing	Seal missing	Seal missing
River Wash	Sun Monolith	Sandstone Labyrinth	Canyon Sentry	Solar Altar Arch

The initial hunch by the dry wash was only the first link. To unlock the Sanctuary and stand before the Oracle, we must traverse the full expanse of the Grand Desert Map and recover each missing seal from its landmark. Our course is set north-north-east, toward the shadow of the Sun Monolith.

The Sun Monolith & Cairn II

I. The Ridge of the Sun

On the high north-eastern ridge stands the Sun Monolith, an ancient obelisk of red sandstone carved by the founders of the Order. At its foot rests Cairn II, a stepped pedestal surrounded by a radial pavement of concentric rings. Here, where the desert horizon stretches unbroken, the architects calibrated their meridian surveys by measuring the shadows cast at true solar noon.

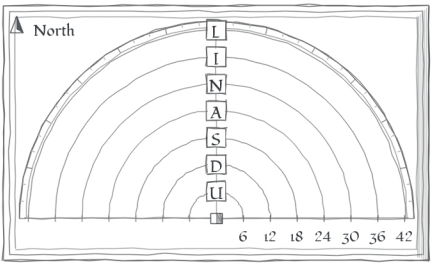


II. The Rules of the Survey

1. The Law of Proportion - At any hour, every upright marker casts a shadow proportional to its height. The surveyor's staff stands two paces tall; the Monolith rises twenty-four paces. Determine the Monolith's shadow for each entry in the ledger.
2. The Meridian Rings - At true solar noon, shadows fall due north across Cairn II. Each concentric ring on the dial marks a measured distance in paces from the Monolith at the center.
3. The Order of the Sigil - Locate the ring for each calculated shadow. The letter tablet carved upon that ring yields one character of the sigil, following the ledger from Noon I to VII.

III. The Seven Noons

Noon	Staff shadow paces	Monolith shadow paces	Dial letter
I	1.5		
II	0.5		
III	2.5		
IV	1		
V	3		
VI	2		
VII	3.5		



The dial of Cairn II (rings in paces)
The Monolith stands at the centre.

The Sigil of Cairn II:

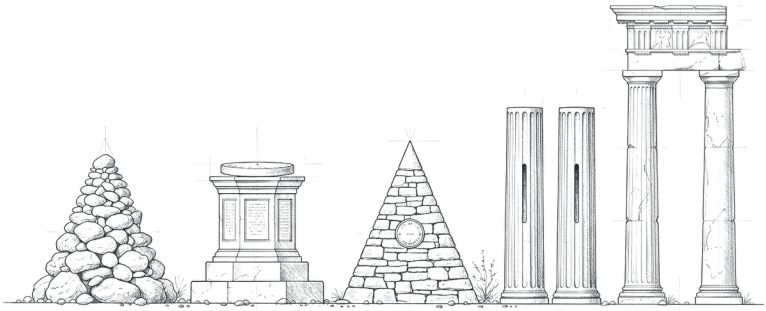
I	II	III	IV	V	VI	VII

Transcribe the seven-letter sigil to align the meridian survey and claim the seal of Cairn II.

The Five Geodetic Cairns

I. The Markers of the Order

Across the open desert, the Order of the Eclipse raised five sacred cairns to anchor their surveys. Each marker marks a vital turn across the waste, binding the earth to the positions of the sun and stars. In these field sketches, I have recorded the elevation and character of every cairn, that their ancient foundations may be recognized across the sands.



Cairn I Cairn II Cairn III Cairn IV Cairn V

II. The Words of the Servant

When I reached the portico of Tower II, the Sanctuary Servant studied the sandstone seal in my palm and pointed his staff toward the vast basin: «You hold only the first piece of the circuit. The founders raised five sacred cairns to measure this desert; without all five, these doors remain barred forever.» Then, tracing the ancient meridian lines upon the flagstones, he revealed the secret of the fallen stones.

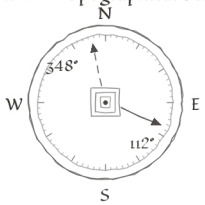
The Memory of the Stones (1971-1998)

«Three of the five cairns collapsed in the autumn of 1971, when the great earthquake shook the basin and the red storm swept across the wastes. For twenty-seven years their foundations lay buried under shifting silt and river sand.

In the autumn of 1998, a young traveler walked the dry wash and raised three mounds of dry stone to guide those who might follow, setting a copper benchmark plate beneath the third. He believed he was merely marking his own trail across the sands. He did not know that his hands were rebuilding the sacred stations of the Order upon their ancient bedrock foundations.

A stone remembers the hand that raises it. That is why your fingers knew the rocks in the riverbed; you were returning to what you had already begun. But Cairns IV and V, far in the southern gorges, never fell. Go back to the sands, surveyor: the desert yields its seals only to the one who walks the complete meridian.»

Cairn III · Topographical Survey



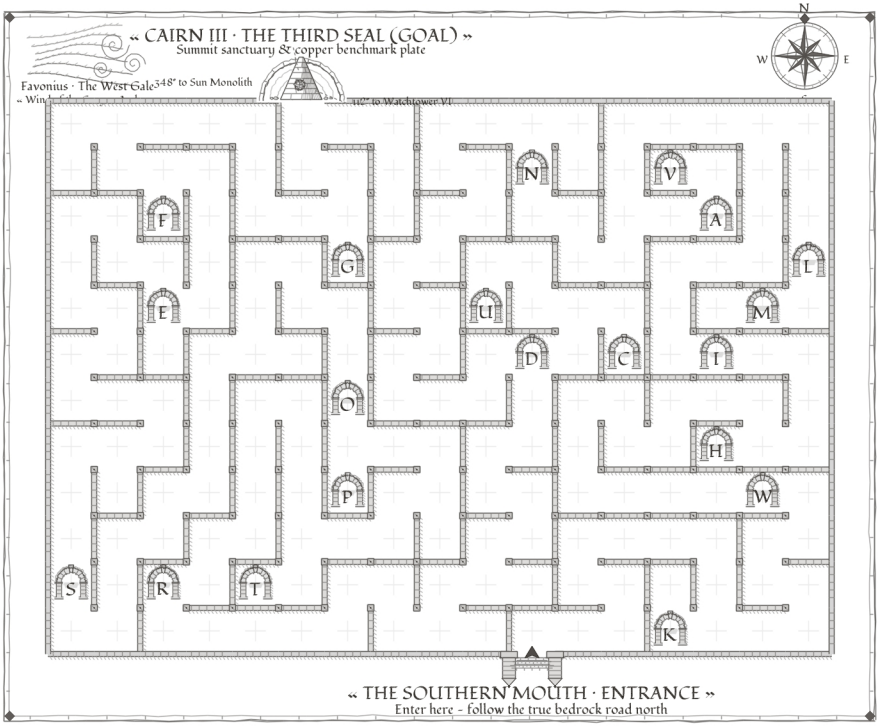
1. The Copper Benchmark (1998): Set at 112° E, pointing toward Outer Watchtower VI across the northern sands.
2. The Bedrock Groove (Ancient): Cut into the foundation at 348° NNW, aligned directly with the Sun Monolith.
3. The Sandstone Labyrinth: Cairn III crowns the deep fissures ahead. Trace the true route on Sheet 14B to recover the third seal.

Meridian Alignment: The 348° axis connects directly with the solar line of Tower II. Walk north across the plateau.

The Sandstone Labyrinth & Cairn III

I. The Arches of the West Wind

North of the Sun Monolith, the open desert rises into a wild plateau of wind-carved sandstone. Here, centuries of scouring gales have sculpted a labyrinth of towering pillars, narrow fissures, and natural arches. Deep within this maze stands Cairn III, guarding the third seal of the Order beneath its copper benchmark plate. The ancient wagon tracks have long vanished beneath shifting sand, but the bedrock itself remembers the way.



II. The Tablet at the Mouth

At the entrance to the gorge, half-buried in silt, stands a weather-worn sandstone stele left by the early surveyors. Before stepping between the towering walls, I copied its inscription into my log:

> «Only one continuous road cuts through the labyrinth from this entrance to the summit of Cairn III. Eight stone arches stand upon that true path, each bearing a single letter. Follow the way step by step, reading the arches in the exact order you pass beneath them. Heed not the shadows of the side fissures: the arches that lie off the path are false.»

The Sigil of Cairn III:

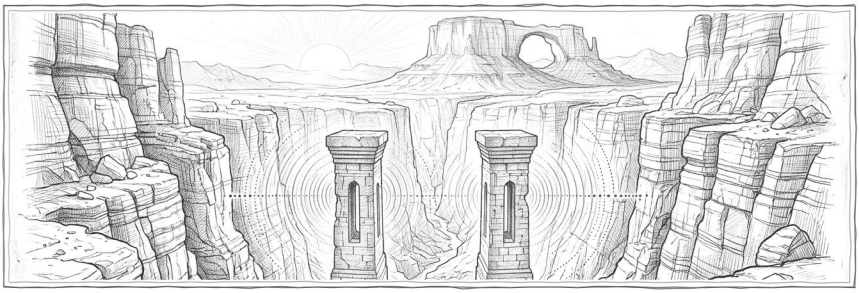
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Speak this eight-letter name at Cairn III to unlock its copper plate and claim the third seal.

Cairn IV: Sentry of the Canyon

I. The Mouth of the Chasm

Beyond the sandstone labyrinth, the desert narrows into the towering corridor of the Whispering Chasm. Here, beneath the Sentinel Mesa, stand two hollow stone pillars: Cairn IV, the Sentry of the Canyon. When the wind rushes through their carved chambers, the pillars sing across the gorge, each stone throwing its voice toward its own cliff wall. To claim the fourth seal, Silvia must follow the cadence of the canyon and discover where each echo was born.

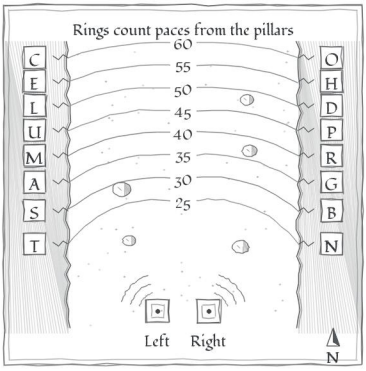


II. The Rules of the Echo

To decipher the echoes recorded in the survey log, observe three simple laws:

1. Direction - The Left pillar echoes only against the left cliff; the Right pillar echoes only against the right cliff.
2. Distance - Sound travels to the rock and back. Each beat of time measured on the chronometer equals 5 paces of distance to the cliff.
3. The Letters - Find that distance ring on the survey plan to read the carved letter. Transcribe the seven echoes in order to reveal the Sigil of the Sentry.

III. The Seven Echoes



Echo	Pillar	Back after	Letter
1	Right	8 beats	
2	Left	11 beats	
3	Left	6 beats	
4	Right	12 beats	
5	Left	9 beats	
6	Right	5 beats	
7	Right	10 beats	

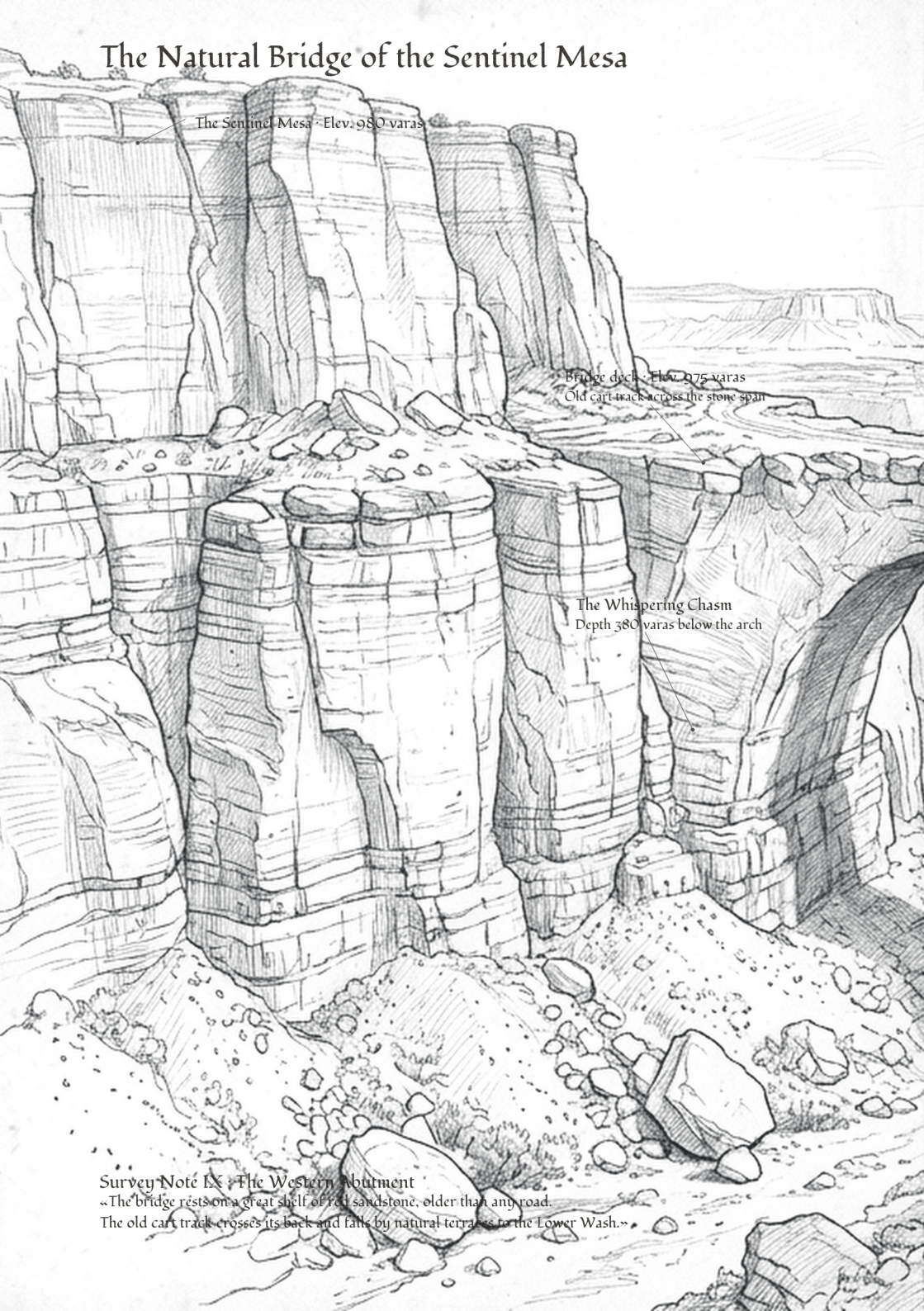
Survey log of the seven echoes

The Sigil of the Sentry:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7

Speak this seven-letter name at Cairn IV to claim the fourth seal.

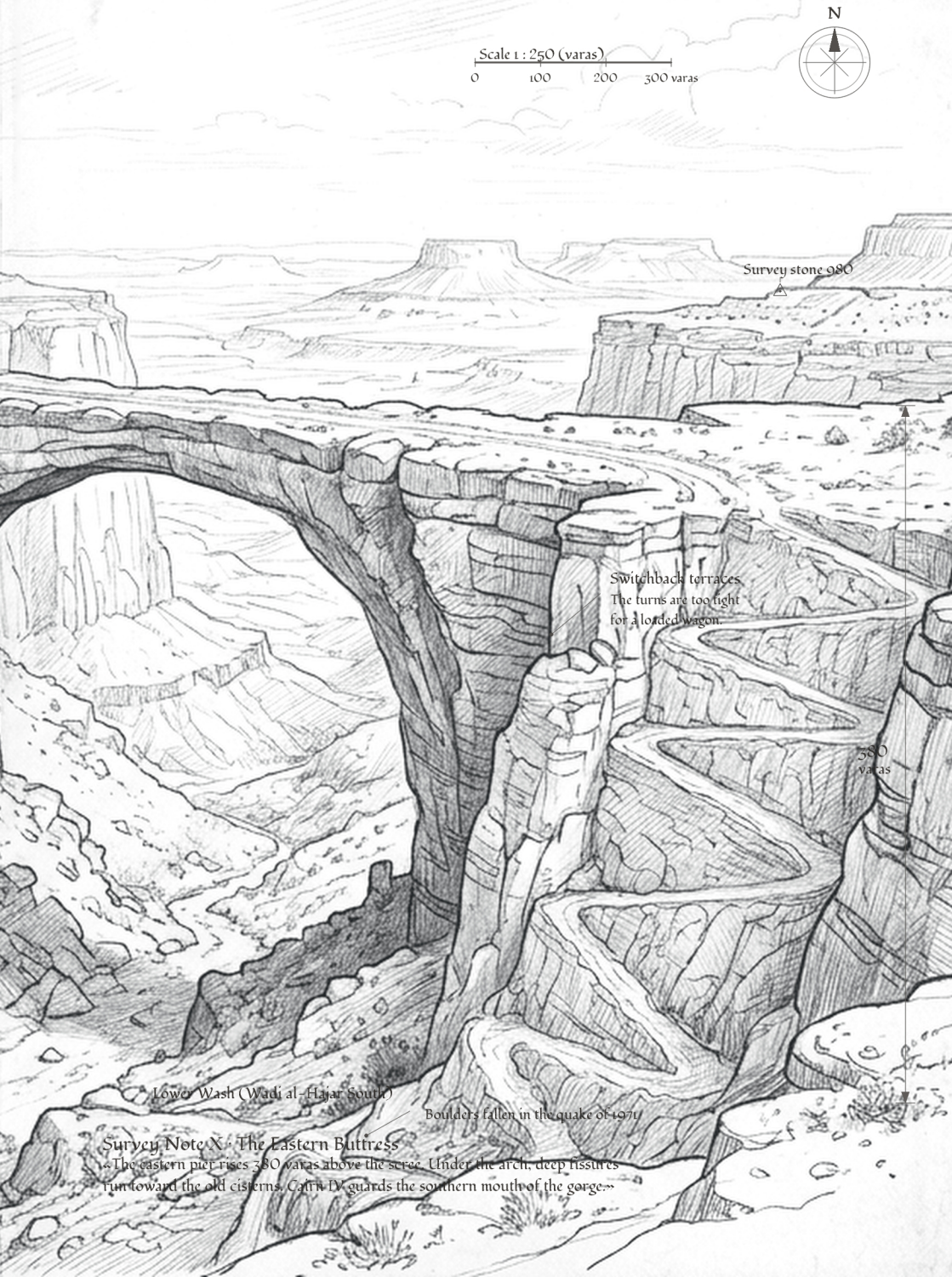
The Natural Bridge of the Sentinel Mesa



Survey Note IX · The Western Abutment

«The bridge rests on a great shelf of red sandstone, older than any road. The old cart track crosses its back and falls by natural terraces to the Lower Wash.»

The Eastern Buttress & Lower Wash



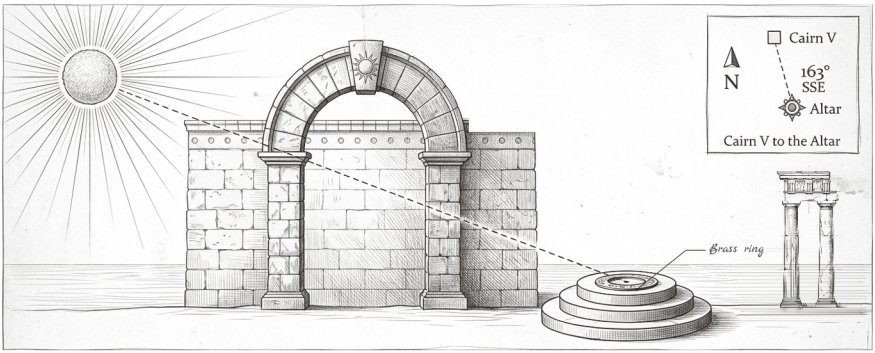
Survey Note X · The Eastern Buttress

«The eastern pier rises 380 varas above the scree. Under the arch, deep fissures run toward the old cisterns. Cairn IV guards the southern mouth of the gorge.»

Arch of the Solstice & The Solar Altar

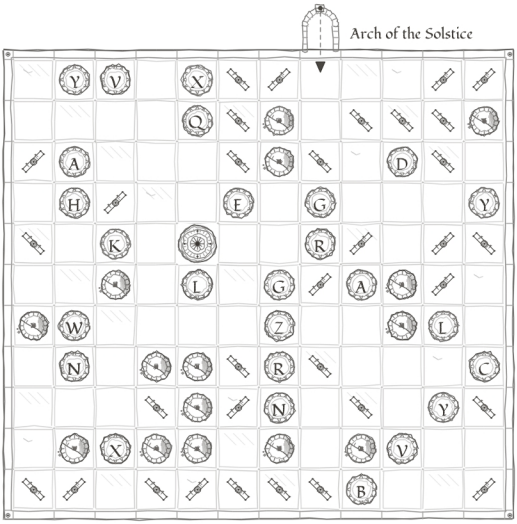
I. The Arch at the Edge of the Sands

Beyond the chasm, the trail opens before Tower II: the Sandstone Sanctuary. Here stands the Arch of the Solstice, and on the terrace rests the Solar Altar. From the dunes (163°), Cairn V watches as the fifth and final marker. At midsummer dawn, the sun's first ray slips beneath the arch. Guided by bronze mirrors, the beam weaves through the courtyard to strike the altar and reveal the last seal.



Arch of the Solstice — The Solar Altar — Cairn V

II. The Courtyard of Rays



1. The ray enters at the arch (see arrow) and travels straight down the courtyard.
2. Bronze mirrors reflect the ray 90° along their slant. Fallen pillars stop the light.
3. Follow the true beam to the Solar Altar. Record each lettered sun-stone crossed, in order, to reveal the eight-letter Sigil.

Key

- Bronze mirror
- Fallen pillar
- Sun-stone (a letter)
- The Solar Altar (the goal)

> Cartographer's note
> «A true mirror does not choose its path. It only reflects the light it receives.»

The Sigil of Cairn V:

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8

Speak this eight-letter Sigil at Cairn V to claim the fifth and final seal.

The Polybius Stele

Trial of the Sanctuary Servant - The Cipher of Cairn III (348* NNW)

	I	II	III	IV	V
I	P	H	O	E	N
II	I	X	A	B	C
III	D	F	G	K	L
IV	M	Q	R	S	T
V	U	V	W	Y	Z

The Law of the Inverted Mirage (Double Sight):

1. Solar Stanzas (Odd: I, III, V): Direct stone reading - coordinates are (Row, Column).

2. Lunar Stanzas (Even: II, IV, VI): Inverted by desert mirage - read as (Column, Row).

The Scribed Coordinates of the Desert Pillars:

I. (IV, IV) (IV, V) (II, III) (IV, III) (IV, IV) [5 Letters]

II. (III, III) (I, V) (I, II) (I, III) (IV, I) [5 Letters]

III. (IV, V) (I, II) (I, III) (IV, IV) (I, IV) [5 Letters]

IV. (III, V) (II, I) (III, I) [3 Letters]

V. (IV, IV) (I, IV) (I, IV) (III, IV) [4 Letters]

VI. (V, IV) (III, IV) (I, V) (V, IV) (II, I) [5 Letters]

The Decoded Nomadic Proverb (Inscribe each letter into its stone):

I II III

IV V VI

The Desert Oracle

For three weeks I traversed this furnace of dust convinced that celestial mathematics alone could resolve our quest. I believed the recovered Astrolabe was self-sufficient-that every secret of the Order lay charted in distant light. I was arrogant. The heavens may trace the celestial dial, but the earth demands a living keeper.

Past the red pillars, following a dry salt riverbed, I caught the scent of burning cedar. Hidden beneath a massive sandstone overhang was his base: a stone sanctuary dwelling sheltered by coarse canvas, flanked by stone cairns and alignment stakes driven into the dust.

From the ridge above, I watched him for hours. He ignored the constellations, instead pouring red sand through his palms and arranging black river stones upon a weathered table. When he turned, his face was entirely lost within his cowl, yet he looked straight toward my perch. He knew I was there before my boots touched the stone.

My judgment of this Oracle is unequivocal: he is unsettling and secretive, yet utterly indispensable. He guards the terrestrial coordinates lost to our Order - the buried anchor required to unlock the Astrolabe.

I cannot approach him; my tools belong to the stars. But you, Silvia, who unraveled the eight seals of this journal, possess eyes that see both sky and dust. Seek his outpost when shadows lengthen. The Desert Path is yours.

The Oracle's Horizon

I. The Oracle's Parchment

Deep within Tower II, the desert wind falls quiet. Silvia stands before the Desert Oracle, knowing neither the What, the Where, nor the How. Here, carved into the ancient sandstone, the Oracle grants her first great revelation: the WHEN—the hour and season ordained under the stars. The Where awaits her in the Stage Path beyond, and the What will only be unveiled upon her final return to the mountain heights. Guide eight beacons of light east across the three horizon mirrors to seal this first truth.

II. The Three Mirrors of the Horizon

1. Sequence – Guide Beacons 1 to 8 east across Mirror I, then Mirror II, and finally Mirror III.
2. The Stepped Horizon – A mirror reflects a beacon straight across to the same distance on the other side: vertical mirrors keep the row. Mirror II follows the sanctuary: Column 6 reflects across Row D (The Altar); other columns reflect across Row F (The Terrace).
3. The Sigil – Note where Beacons 1 to 8 land after all three reflections. Write their letters in order into the reliquary below to reveal the Sigil of the Oracle.

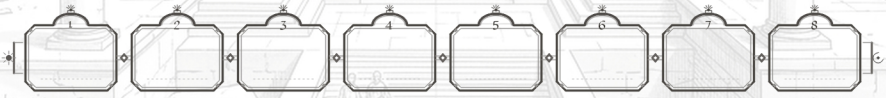
	Mirror I · Meridian				Mirror II				Mirror III · Stage						
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
A	L	(1)	W		T	W	W	U	P		O	E	A	R	V	A
B	M	H	O		M	O	S	B	U		I	Y	L	B	V	V
C	(2)	P	(3)		N	B	C	R	O		F	S	L	C	L	W
D	P	(4)	W		F			U	U	W	R	M	M	R	E	P
E	D	U	B		U			Y	D	S	N	R	S	F	H	H
F	(5)	D	(6)								T	C	T	U	U	W
G	U	(7)	N		D	S	O	N	G		I	D	T	O	W	G
H	N	Y	(8)		L	S	P	I	T		O	F	U	G	L	V
I	S	G	E		T	Y	S	U	S		W	F	V	U	E	L

The Altar · Row D

The Terrace · Row F

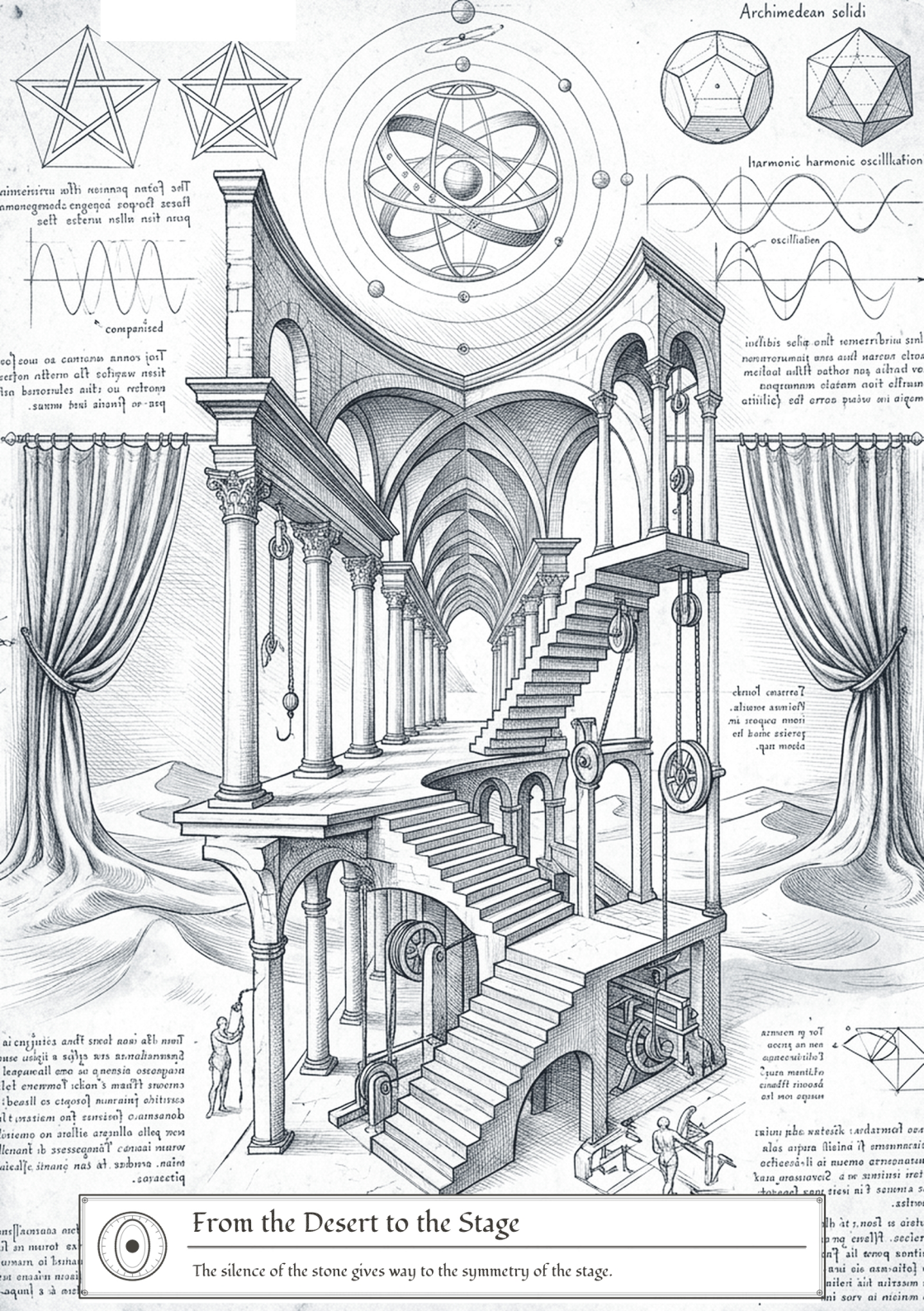
Oriens · East

THE SIGIL OF THE ORACLE



« Speak the eight-letter Sigil to the Oracle to open the road to the Stage. »

The road ends where the curtain rises.



From the Desert to the Stage

The silence of the stone gives way to the symmetry of the stage.